closely with the law enforcement agencies. Military Intelligence operates as an intelligence collection agency and as the research body responsible for the national assessment of war; in those cases where it is required to enforce the law, it is assisted by the IDF's Information Security Department (formerly Operations Security), which is subordinate to the head of MI and the Military Advocate General's Office. These two bodies work with the state prosecutor. The work of the Israel Police is generally intertwined with the law enforcement system. Their relationship is very tight, though not without tension.

The difference between the concept of "intelligence as proof" and the concept of legal proof has always been obvious to those engaged in intelligence gathering in the Shin Bet and the Israel Police, and less so for Military Intelligence and the Mossad, because the latter two's contacts with the law enforcement system are minimal and loose by nature. For the Mossad, this situation changed after the First Gulf War, when it became heavily involved in the issue of nuclear proliferation and was also given responsibility for prevention. When you are engaged in the area of prevention, law enforcement agents become your partners. As an intelligence officer, you have the job of providing intelligence that proves that someone—a person or company—is indeed providing the enemy with prohibited knowledge and technologies. The job of law enforcement agencies is to bring the person or company to court and convict them. In many cases, their demands of you as the provider of intelligence are extremely rigorous because the intelligence must stand the test of criminal law—proof beyond any reasonable doubt—in order to obtain a conviction. This tension between the two bodies requires you as an intelligence collection agency to take additional risks, often endangering human lives, and to invest even more human resources and money only to meet the requirements of the law and to prove what to you seems completely obvious. In the war in which the free world finds itself today, a war in which there exists an absolute asymmetry between a moral society and a society devoid of values, there is certainly an argument to be made regarding the lowering of the bar of legal requirements on issues related to the war on terror.

At this point I will play the role of Cato the Elder (the Roman senator who used to finish all his speeches with the words, "And, additionally, Carthage should be destroyed") and raise a subject that appears to me one that is convenient for the Western world to avoid dealing with. This issue is